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Legislative ethics watchdog quits

McCuskey to leave post after tenure clouded by investigation into Springfield sexual harassment

By Rick Pearson
and Jeremy Gerner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Michael McCuskey, the Illinois legislature's top ethics watchdog, is resigning the post after his tenure has become clouded by recent controversy following his investigation that determined a former state lawmaker's sexual harassment

of women violated state law.

McCuskey, a former state and federal judge, submitted a letter of resignation on Aug. 31 to the eight-member bipartisan, bicameral Legislative Ethics Commission. As the commission was posting a notice of vacancy in the office, McCuskey said he submitted an end date for his employment of Sept. 30 to finish his work.

It was unclear if the commission, made up of four Democrats and four Republicans, with two members from each of the House and Senate caucuses, would accept McCuskey's end date or act to have him removed sooner. The commission also has the power to terminate McCuskey for cause.

But by posting the notice of vacancy and the process to fill it, the commission made it clear it was taking steps to remove McCuskey, who was appointed by the legislature in February 2022 to a term

ending in mid-2028.

Questions about McCuskey have become one more issue in the larger controversy over sexual harassment inside the Illinois Capitol, where now-former state Rep. Harry Benton, a Plainfield Democrat, resigned in July amid an investigation by McCuskey's office.

While McCuskey found Benton had violated state law by engaging in sexual harassment, one of Benton's victims, a female lobbyist, raised



Michael McCuskey, then-chair of the board of trustees for Illinois State University, on April 22, 2014. ZBIGNIEW BZDAK/TRIBUNE

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EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Residents protest railroad proposal

Chicagoans protesting against Amtrak moving a maintenance facility into their community attend a press conference across from Rate Field on Tuesday. The Amtrak facility would be adjacent to the current White Sox stadium in a residential neighborhood, according to the proposed plan, and the stadium would move to a South Loop location on the Chicago River. **Business**

Englewood native shows never too late to reach goal

Despite starts and stops, woman earns doctorate from DePaul at age 75

By Darcel Rockett
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Englewood native Deniece Rogers didn't celebrate her 2011 bachelor's degree, or her 2015 master's degree. But when she crossed the finish line with her doctorate, she threw a party for herself because "that one, she felt."

At 75, the Near North Side resident earned her Doctorate of Philosophy in Educational Leadership from DePaul University's College of Education in June, despite the many starts and stops she endured because of health concerns.

"It was the big mama," she said, laughing about her last credential. "That one I felt because I had gone through so much to get there. I'm really glad that I didn't drop out."

Rogers never began high school. Yet more than a half century later, with grit and persistence, she has emerged as an academic unicorn — so unique and nearly unheard of that there is no official count of others like her — a senior citizen who completed her doctorate at 75 years old.

While just 2.5% of students

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John Catanzara, president of the Chicago Fraternal Order of Police, departs after speaking during a news conference on April 27 at the Leighton Criminal Court Building. BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE

Feds demand FOP president's financial, governance records

By Caroline Kubzansky
and Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Federal investigators issued a subpoena to the Illinois Fraternal Order of Police late last year for an FBI probe into Chicago's FOP President John Catanzara's financial dealings, according to a copy of the document reviewed by the Tribune.

The subpoena, dated October 2025 and sent as part of a grand jury investigation,

demands that Illinois FOP personnel turn over a slew of financial and governance records dating back to October 2020. Among the records sought were expense vouchers, reimbursement forms and receipts. The subpoena was issued from the Northern District of Illinois, although the Illinois FOP is based in Springfield.

Catanzara — long a lightning rod for controversy who has represented the Chicago Police

Department's rank and file since May 2020 — is the only person named in the document. He took a leave of absence from his role as the first vice president of the state police union in October 2025.

Reached by phone for comment Tuesday afternoon, Catanzara told the Tribune that he had not seen the subpoena issued to the state lodge, and said he had not testified to the

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Trade war between US, Canada escalates

Trump targets dairy, alcohol after Carney hit US imports with tariffs

By Rob Gillies
and Paul Wiseman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

The United States is banning dairy products, most alcoholic beverages and motorcycles from Canada, the White House said Tuesday, as the trade war between the two neighbors and longtime allies escalates.

The ban will take effect in three weeks and comes after Canada imposed retaliatory tariffs on \$20 billion in U.S. imports earlier Tuesday.

President Donald Trump also moved Tuesday to shut Canadian products out of large, long-term U.S. government contracts as Canada's retaliatory tariffs took effect and Prime Minister Mark Carney vowed to speed efforts to reduce the country's dependence on the United States.

Trump directed the U.S. General Services Administration to declare Canadian products ineligible for those contracts until Canada allows "full and fair reciprocity" for American products.

Carney said Tuesday Canada's strategy was about becoming more independent. "It's about ensuring that no country can hold us hostage. And that we can live how we want to live."

The rupture has upended one of the world's closest relationships. On Aug. 22, the U.S. imposed 50% tariffs on about 5% of Canadian imports, charging that Canada had unfairly treated the American dairy, alcoholic beverage and auto industries.

The U.S. and Canada have long sparred over trade, particularly Canada's protected dairy market and its subsidies for producers of softwood lumber. But they remained friends and staunch allies.

Under Trump, U.S.-Canada relations have deteriorated rapidly.

In addition to imposing tariffs on Canadian products, Trump has

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INSIDE

Crazy season gets interesting for Sox



The White Sox are close to pulling off one of the most amazing sports stories in years — going to the postseason two years after setting a modern major-league record with 121 losses. Every game carries weight these days, and the pressure is on manager Will Venable and his players. **Sports**

Lemonade legend

Meet Mario DiPaolo Jr. of Mario's Italian Lemonade in Little Italy, where summer starts and ends in Chicago. **Food & Health**

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